

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

budget because the driver was uninsured. Needless to say, they were both getting very weary and questioning, "What next?"

The last straw came when they had their station wagon loaded to go on vacation. A shorted wire caught fire and destroyed their wagon—totally. They said they knew it was time to give up and concede that they were never going to make their "dream" trip.

My question was, "Are you going to quit so easily?" It took about five minutes to get them calmed down enough to ask the second question, "Have you ever really surrendered this area over to God and asked Him to help you take the vacation you desire?" They hadn't because, as most Christians seem to believe, they didn't think God was interested in vacations. And yet, God's Word clearly outlines His direction for longer vacations than most of us would ever take, one year off out of seven.

I suggested they pray about it, just to be sure that they had peace from the Lord, then share with their Bible study group, Sunday School class, and others. They did so and a Christian in one of the groups said that he had a large recreational vehicle that he rarely used and they were welcome to use it for the three weeks they needed.

It turned out to be the best vacation they had ever taken and they had virtually NO PROBLEMS. It also started a real fellowship within their class as other Christians realized they could share their frustrations and defeats without fear of ridicule.

Entertainment and recreation can certainly get out of control if you're not careful. We're a fast-food generation that seeks constant diversion from reality. Young couples that have come out of families where they ate out a lot will have to practice self-discipline and limit their spending to their budget guidelines.

The most effective way I have found to control the entertainment budget is an envelope system. As stated earlier, the principle is simple: keep an envelope marked "Entertainment"